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Governance | Institutional Readiness | Responsible AI

## INSTITUTIONAL LEADERSHIP

# Danai Hazel Kudya

## Founder & Executive Director

Africa Governance & Civic Innovation Hub (AGCIH)



### Founder & Executive Director

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Danai Hazel Kudya is the founder of the Africa Governance and Civic Innovation Hub (AGCIH), an independent governance institution working at the intersection of public law, institutional design, and AI implementation across Africa. She established AGCIH to fill a precise institutional gap: the absence of a dedicated African governance body capable of operationalising accountability for high-impact digital and AI-enabled public systems.

With more than 15 years of experience in governance, institutional strengthening, and public-interest accountability, Danai brings a practitioner's depth to AGCIH's mission. Her career has spanned independent constitutional commissions, UN entities, and civil society, including the leadership of complex, multi-stakeholder programmes in demanding political and operational environments across Zimbabwe and the continent. That range is not incidental — it informs the practical, implementation-grounded approach that distinguishes AGCIH's work.

As an institutional architect and original thinker in African AI governance, Danai has developed a body of doctrinal work that positions AGCIH as a substantive voice ahead of the field. Her frameworks — including the Continuous Administration doctrine, the administrative risk and institutional absorption concepts, and AGCIH's Procurement Governance Matrix — address the governance gaps that arise when AI systems enter public administration without adequate oversight architecture. This intellectual contribution sets AGCIH apart

from commentary and situates it as a source of governance tools that African regulators, oversight bodies, and governments can apply.

Her engagement spans government ministries, regulatory authorities, and international partners, with a focus on building the institutional capacity that makes responsible AI implementation possible — not merely aspirational. At AGCIH, her strategic leadership translates long-standing expertise in public law and governance reform into the frameworks, standards, and accountability mechanisms that digital-era public institutions require.

### **Areas of Institutional Leadership**

**AI Governance & Accountability** — Developing doctrines, frameworks, and tools for governing AI deployment in public administration across Africa.

**Public Law & Institutional Design** — Applying public law principles to the design of governance architecture for digital and AI-enabled systems.

**Procurement Governance** — Original work on procurement as the critical gateway of digital state power, including the AGCIH Procurement Governance Matrix.

**Regulatory Engagement** — Engaging governments, regulators, and oversight bodies to operationalise accountability for high-impact technologies.

**Institutional Capacity Building** — Strengthening mandates, oversight pathways, and governance readiness so public institutions can implement responsibly.